

# THE LAST LIGHT

TGC Game Jam — Game Proposal

Genre: Horror / Puzzle / Escape | Themes: Comic • Light • Twist | Engine: Godot | Playtime: 10–15 min

## 1. Game Concept

**The Last Light** is a short first-person horror escape game set inside an abandoned house. The player wakes up with no memory of how they got there. Their only tool is a **flashlight with limited battery**. The player must explore the house, find important items, solve puzzles, and escape while avoiding a mysterious creature.

The three TGC themes are directly connected to the gameplay:

- **Light** is the main gameplay and survival mechanic.
- **Comic** is used to reveal the story and clues.
- **Twist** changes the player's understanding of the entire game.

The player slowly discovers that the house is connected to previous attempts and that the truth is much closer than expected.

## 2. Core Gameplay

**Loop:** Explore → Use Light → Discover Clue → Find Item → Avoid Creature → Solve Puzzle → Progress

### Flashlight Mechanic — Light

The flashlight is both the player's **greatest tool and greatest danger**.

| Light ON                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Light OFF                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Hidden objects and clues become visible</li><li>• The player can navigate dark areas</li><li>• Some puzzles can only be solved with light</li><li>• The creature can detect the flashlight</li></ul> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• The player is harder for the creature to detect</li><li>• Exploration becomes difficult</li><li>• Important clues remain hidden</li></ul> |

A simple risk/reward decision: *“Do I turn on the light to see, knowing that something might see me?”*

## 3. Theme Integration

### Theme 1 — LIGHT

Light controls exploration, puzzles, story discovery, and enemy detection. Some symbols, objects, and messages can only be seen when the flashlight shines on them. *Example:* the player enters a dark room and sees nothing; the flashlight reveals a hidden symbol on the wall that becomes the solution to a nearby puzzle.

### Theme 2 — COMIC

The story is presented through **comic-style panels** placed throughout the house, containing dialogue, drawings, sound effects (“BANG!”, “RUN!”), hints, memories and story events. Some panels are invisible until lit by the flashlight, merging **Comic + Light** into one mechanic. *Example:* an empty wall reveals a panel —

*“DON'T TRUST THE LIGHT.”*

The panel disappears when the player moves away, forcing them to remember important information.

### Theme 3 — TWIST

The player believes the goal is simply to escape the creature and leave. During exploration they find records showing **ATTEMPT #01, #17, #32, #46** — they have been inside the house many times before. The final reveal: **the creature is connected to the player's previous attempts**, and the player has been repeating the same journey, losing their memories each time. The final comic panel reads:

*“YOU HAVE BEEN HERE BEFORE.”*

## 4. Story

The player wakes up in a dark bedroom. A message on the wall reads **“DON'T LET THE LIGHT DIE.”** They find a flashlight and begin exploring, revealing hidden comic panels and strange messages. The creature reacts whenever the flashlight is used, so the player must decide when to use the light and when to remain in darkness. While searching for the exit, they discover evidence of previous attempts, and eventually reach the final room to find the truth about the house, the creature, and themselves.

## 5. Level Structure

|                 |                                                                           |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Bedroom      | Player wakes up, finds flashlight, learns basic movement and interaction. |
| 2. Hallway      | First comic clues; introduces light mechanic; first creature encounter.   |
| 3. Storage Room | Find key items; solve a simple light-based puzzle.                        |
| 4. Living Room  | More comic panels; discover evidence of previous attempts.                |
| 5. Basement     | Darker environment; more dangerous encounters; major story reveal.        |
| 6. Exit Area    | Player believes they have escaped; discovers the final clue.              |
| 7. Final Room   | Final comic sequence; reveal of the repeating cycle; final twist.         |

## 6. Complete Gameplay Flow

WAKE UP → FIND FLASHLIGHT → EXPLORE HOUSE → USE LIGHT TO REVEAL CLUES → DISCOVER COMIC PANELS → FIND ITEMS → CREATURE DETECTS LIGHT → HIDE / ESCAPE → SOLVE LIGHT-BASED PUZZLES → DISCOVER PREVIOUS ATTEMPTS → REACH EXIT → FINAL COMIC REVEAL → TWIST: THE PLAYER HAS BEEN HERE BEFORE

## 7. Scope

The scope is intentionally small so that a complete **10–15 minute** experience can be finished within the jam. The game will include:

- First-person player movement
- Flashlight and battery system
- One main creature/enemy
- Simple inventory
- Keys and interactable objects
- Light-based puzzles
- Comic-style story panels
- Small interconnected house
- Hiding and chase sequences
- Environmental storytelling
- Sound effects and horror atmosphere
- Final story twist
- Browser-playable HTML5/Web build

## 8. Development Plan

| Time        | Development                                                      |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hour 0–12   | Finalize concept, prototype movement, flashlight and basic level |
| Hour 12–40  | Build house, puzzles, inventory and creature                     |
| Hour 40–70  | Add Comic, Light and Twist systems                               |
| Hour 70–90  | Story, sound, visuals, balancing and polish                      |
| Hour 90–100 | Testing, bug fixing and final submission                         |

## 9. Theme Dependency

**LIGHT** controls exploration and survival. **COMIC** communicates clues and story. **TWIST** changes the meaning of the clues and story. Removing any one of these would significantly change the gameplay experience.

## Final Pitch

**The Last Light** is a short horror escape game where the flashlight is both your greatest advantage and your greatest danger. **Light helps you see. Light helps you solve. Light also reveals you.** Through comic-style clues, the player slowly uncovers a disturbing truth: **this is not their first escape attempt**. The game combines Comic, Light, and Twist into one simple horror experience designed to be easy to understand, interactive, and memorable within a 10–15 minute playthrough.

## Team Details

| Name               | Email                       | IndieConnect ID   |
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